

Sharepoint Intranet Redesign

National Science Foundation | OIG

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Keywords:

UX Design, UX Research, Sharepoint

Summary:

Wanda's project was working on redesigning web pages on NSF's Sharepoint intranet to improve accessibility and reduce friction when completing actions on the website. This required completing a UX audit, conducting stakeholder interviews, best practice research, and designing within Sharepoint sites.

SHAREPOINT INTRANET REDESIGN

National Science Foundation

OIG

Catherine Doan— IT Manager



Streamlining internal
operations into an
accessible, brand-aligned
intranet experience.

RESEARCH

Exploring the limitations of Sharepoint

BACKGROUND

- The Office of Inspector General (OIG) at the National Science Foundation provides independent oversight of the U.S. National Science Foundation to improve the effectiveness, efficiency, and economy of its programs and operations and to prevent and detect fraud, waste, and abuse.
- Through an internal Sharepoint website, employees are able to access information about training, purchase card requests, and more.

RESEARCH

- **Industry Best Practices:** I researched Nielsen Norman Group's articles on intranet UX principles, which included task-based navigation, scannable content hierarchy, and reducing cognitive load.
- **Design Analysis:** I analyzed external SharePoint intranet site examples and to identify layout trends and effective component usage.
- **Technical Knowledge:** I reviewed SharePoint design tutorials and documentation (YouTube, Microsoft Learn) to understand constraints and Sharepoint best practices.

STAKEHOLDER INTERVIEWS

- Through interviews with HR and Business Ops, I was able to learn more about what questions and pain points teams had. For each interview, I developed a bank of questions to ask how they use the intranet site for different tasks.



KEY DESIGN CHANGES

Improving accessibility and the user journey

GOALS

- In doing an audit of the website, it was determined to update the design of the Purchase Card page, the Training Request page, the Brand Assets page, and the Business Card Request page.

DESIGN CHANGES

- Unifying pages managed by different teams under one brand and visual identity.
- Unifying components and patterns across pages such as timelines, FAQ sections, header images, quick links/navigational elements, call out boxes, and charts.
- Exploring summarizing content and simplifying overwhelming blocks of text through the use of collapsible components, simplifying language, and input from subject matter experts.
- Exploring the use of icons, infographics, and diagrams to summarize text blocks.

IMPACT

- **Stakeholder Alignment:** Interfaced with cross-functional OIG teams to map key user needs.
- **Content Simplification:** Identified opportunities to condense dense policy information.
- **Phased Roadmap:** Outlined a structured framework to make complex processes easy to follow.

REFLECTIONS/LESSONS LEARNED

- **Working Within Ecosystem Constraints**

I learned to maximize SharePoint's native design capabilities, despite the limitations of the platform and lack of flexibility.

- **Information Architecture**

I learned that organizing site navigation around user intent rather than including every detail drastically speeds up how quickly employees find critical resources.

- **Collaboration**

I appreciated learning how the teams across OIG function and collaborate with each other.

THANK YOU